

Chapter 53_2: Figure

The shattered jade struck Qiu Yi's head, causing her to cry out "Ow!" She was about to scold angrily but held back because Chu Qing Qiu was present, only glaring at Ning Fu Yi.

Chu Qing Qiu hadn't expected this either. She strode back to Ning Fu Yi's side, lifted her sleeve, and placed her warm fingertips on the Quchi acupoint¹, holding for a moment before releasing.

Her expression changed dramatically: "When did your cultivation advance so rapidly?"

Ning Fu Yi opened her mouth to answer, but remembering there was still someone present, she looked toward Qiu Yi. Chu Qing Qiu didn't hesitate, raising her hand to seal Qiu Yi's ears.

"Speak," she said indifferently.

Chu Qing Qiu was extremely righteous, so although Ning Fu Yi had originally disliked her, she had never distrusted her. Now she was even less afraid, so she told her everything about the changes after drawing the divine sword.

"Could it be that Divine Venerable doesn't know about this matter?" Ning Fu Yi then probed.

Chu Qing Qiu had never expressed even half a bit of curiosity about her changes. So she guessed that Chu Qing Qiu should know something about what was happening to her.

"I guessed half of it," Chu Qing Qiu didn't respond directly to her probing. "I just didn't expect your cultivation would reach the Clear Realm² so quickly in just a few days."

At these words, Ning Fu Yi herself was shocked. She knew her immortal power was becoming increasingly abundant, but having never properly cultivated immortal arts, she thought she had only broken through one level. She hadn't expected to leap through two entire realm levels.

It was both surprising and delightful.

"May this disciple ask—does Divine Venerable know why this cultivation has grown so rapidly?" she asked. "Is it because of the divine sword?"

Chu Qing Qiu shook her head. This time she wasn't avoiding the question—she truly didn't know.

There were actually secrets about Ning Fu Yi that even she didn't know. Chu Qing Qiu felt somewhat dazed.

"The immortal power in your body doesn't seem naturally born, but rather obtained through some kind of opportunity, yet it has merged with your immortal meridians as if they were one." Chu Qing Qiu said softly. "But if it were external immortal power, it would be difficult to harmonize so well with oneself."

"Moreover, if it's an unknown power, or an overly powerful force used forcibly, it might cause backlash and lead to cultivation deviation³." Chu Qing Qiu concentrated.

"I've been using it quite smoothly..." Ning Fu Yi looked at her palm. "But how can I know the source of this power?"

Chu Qing Qiu's eyes flickered without speaking. She originally wanted to grab her collar as before, but raising her hand, she realized Ning Fu Yi was now almost the same height as her. So she lowered her hand and instead grasped the palace sash⁴ hanging from Ning Fu Yi's belt.

Then white light flashed. When Ning Fu Yi opened her eyes again, before her was a vast pool with white mist rising from the water—it was the familiar Bone-Scattering Cold Pool⁵.

The last time she had awakened here, she had still wanted to kill Chu Qing Qiu. She hadn't expected time to pass so quickly.

"Remove your clothes and go in," Chu Qing Qiu said.

Footnotes:

1. **Quchi acupoint (曲池穴):** A specific acupuncture point on the arm used in Traditional Chinese Medicine, often associated with energy flow and cultivation
2. **Clear Realm (明境):** The fourth level in the established cultivation system after Initial Realm, Mortal Realm, and Rising Realm
3. **Cultivation deviation (走火入魔):** A dangerous condition where a cultivator's energy goes out of control, potentially leading to madness or death
4. **Palace sash (宫绦):** A decorative silk cord or ribbon worn as part of formal robes, often indicating status or sect affiliation
5. **Bone-Scattering Cold Pool (散骨寒潭):** A special pool with healing and purifying properties, previously mentioned in the story